Nordic Basic Scientific Computing 2026

Finnish (+ friends) RSE Meetup

About the Event

The Finnish and friends RSE (Research Software Engineer) Meetup brings together people in Finland (and beyond) who develop or support research through software, data, and computing. Whether your title is RSE, scientist, data specialist, or IT support, if you're helping research through code or computational tools - this event is for you. This is also for you, the RSE enthusiast, who enjoys the coding part of research work more or just as much as the research part.

Why a Finnish RSE Meetup?

While Nordic-RSE connects the regional community, this Finnish meetup provides a national focus for collaboration and sharing. It helps us:

- Discuss challenges and opportunities specific to Finnish institutions and funding structures
- Strengthen local networks and identify national needs (training, recognition, career paths)
- Coordinate efforts between universities, research institutes, and infrastructure providers like CSC

This meetup complements the Nordic-RSE community by creating a space for practical cooperation within Finland, while staying connected to the wider Nordic and international RSE movements.

Who Should Join

- Researchers and research software engineers developing or maintaining research code
- Data and computing specialists supporting research workflows
- IT staff, educators, and research managers interested in improving research software practices
- Early-career researchers curious about RSE career paths

No formal RSE title is needed - if you develop, or support research software, you belong here.

Why Participate

By joining, you can:

- Meet peers from across Finnish universities and research institutes
- Learn how RSE groups and initiatives are organized in Finland
- Share your own experiences, needs, and ideas for national cooperation
- Help shape the future of Finnish/Nordic RSE activities - training, recognition, and community events

Good to know

This part of the event is sponsored by the Society of Research Software Engineering. Therefore we can keep the registration for free and offer lunch, coffee and snacks during the event. Therefore, please only register to this second half of the event, if you plan to attend in person to avoid any food waste.

Travel funding

Thanks to the Software Sustainability Institute we have some travel funding (travel + one night accomodation) available for you to visit the RSE-FI meetup (day 1+2).

More information at Travel funding for the RSE meetup

Organizers

The meetup is organized by Finnish members of Nordic-RSE with support from the Software Sustainability institute (via SSI fellowship of Samantha Wittke). Facilities are provided by Aalto Scientific Computing (ASC).

For any questions, ideas or if you would like to join the organizing committee, please contact samantha.wittke@csc.fi.

Scientific computing team meetup

About the event

This meetup is targeted towards people in local Scientific Computing (SciComp)/Research computing/Research Software Engineer support teams, for example university local HPC teams. We work in local capacity and are often overshadowed by the big national e-infrastructure providers (CSC, EuroHPC, etc) in attention and funding, yet we are the ones “on the ground” with the researchers. What’s our place in the world?

We have our own unique challenges and opportunities. This is a time we can talk together and learn from each other. (Others are of course welcome.) Maybe we can make a strategy for working together or getting some national funding?

Who should join?

For example, many of the teams that were part of the old Finnish Grid Infrastructure at univerities or local partners of the CodeRefinery collaboration. Really, if you work with Aalto Scientific Computing you are strongly invited and we'll have some fun discussions. If you don't, you are invited anyway.

Academic conferences usually don't suit us, but we need a community. Our job is important and challenging, and we can't do it alone. NoBSC is the right level for the networking we need to succeed at our jobs.

In this first iteration, we especially welcome people who support academic research through computing and data expertise in universities and research institutions, for example those in local HPC or RSE teams, cloud computing, and other computing services for researchers. But everyone is welcome: including those who might want these kind of jobs in the future.

Program ideas

We can especially talk about:

- Local resources and teams in a time when computing is becoming more centralized.
- Local services we run, how they compare to national services.
- Advantages and disadvantages of being positioned locally.
- What types of infrastructure funding we could apply for to increase our benefit or make (inter-)national collaborations. (Dedicated session: Wednesday afternoon)

Cool things and problems

Everyone will have a chance to (and be encouraged) to contribute to the session "Cool things and problems". In this, each team presents three cool things they are doing, and three problems they are facing. We can then see.

Good to know

There is no registration fee, but also no food, snacks, coffe, and dinner provided for this part of the event. We will have to divide into smaller groups for lunch and dinners and distribute to various restaurants.

Organizers

Richard Darst (richard.darst atsign aalto.fi) is organizing this half.

Practical info

Location

Aalto University Campus, (Espoo), Helsinki Area. If you search `Dipoli` in a map service it should find it, the address is `Otakaari 24, 02150 Espoo`.

Food

For the Finnish and Friends RSE meetup on Monday/Tuesday we will have food available according to dietary restrictions provided during registration. For others we will have a reservation at restaurants in the campus area. These restaurants can generally cater to all common diets, including vegetarian, vegan, gluten free, and lactose free. There are also two grocery stores at the metro station (*A* entrance).

Map

See full screen

Tourist information and other activities

Wikivoyage Helsinki is usually pretty accurate and has information about the area and other sights to see.

Hotels

There are various hotels within easy walking distance. We don't have any particular discounts. "Radison Blu Otaniemi" is the default location for university visitors. Other hotels in Helsinki downtown are fine also, the metro trip is 11 minutes (and costs ~3 euros).

Arrival

tldr: Aalto University is at the "Aalto University" metro stop. An "ABC" ticket manages the train from airport AND metro (and trams, busses, etc).

Air: Helsinki Airport. Between the airport and Aalto University, plan for max 1.5 hours (less than one hour is possible if you are efficient). From the airport, follow signs to the train station. Board a train and immediately use a contactless payment card to buy an ABC ticket at a card reader; this will get you all the way to the university (see public transport). Take the first train that comes (either way gets to downtown in about the same time). From the main station, walk to the connected metro station. Take a metro to the stop Aalto University (direction Tapiola or Kivenlahti), then continue in section "public transport" below.

Ferry: From Tallinn or Stockholm, there are ferries. Expect well under an hour to get from the ferry harbors to Aalto University. Take trams to the metro, but from each harbor walking to the metro is reasonable (not too far and nice walks). (Some attendees are also attending the Nordic e-infrastructure Conference in Tallinn on 27-29 May, they will be taking ferries from Tallinn the evening of 29 May. More info to be announced)

Bus, Train, etc. within Finland: You probably know how to get to the center of Helsinki. Follow public transit below.

Private vehicle: There isn't free parking, but there are paid lots around.

Public transport: The public transport system is good and easy to use. The metro stop name is "Aalto University", and the A exit is closer to us. Tickets can be bought at ticket machines, or via the "HSL App". Aalto University is in the zone B, downtown is in the zone A, the airport in zone C, and tickets last a bit more than an hour and work on any public bus, train, metro, or tram (and as many transfers as you need). AB zone tickets cost about 3€.

If coming from airport: use single tickets, day tickets not worth it even with one extra trip to/from downtown.

Now, all tickets can be bought using contactless payment cards (details). Select the appropriate zones (AB or ABC) at the blue readers (before getting on the metro, after boarding bus/train/tram), then show your card. More info and ways to pay.

Code of conduct

Attendees are expected to follow the Aalto University code of conduct. Realisically you won't read it, so here the general idea :

- There will be attendees at a wide variety of points in their RSE/SciComp career. Try to understand them and help them go.
- There will be attendees who know more or fewer other attendees. Take active steps to include them in your conversations:
  - Leave spaces in your circle for others to join, if you see someone hovering, invite them in and fill them in on what you are talking about.
  - Give special attention to understanding who is in your discussion groups and making sure you are talking at the right level.
- This is a bottom-up event to support your networking. Please help out if see something to improve and you have time and ability.
- Tell Richard or Samantha if you need something.

About

Organizers

- Richard Darst, Aalto University (co-lead, RC/SciComp part)
- Samantha Wittke, CSC - IT Center for Science (co-lead, RSE-FI)
- Luca Ferranti, Aalto University
- Ina Pöhner, University of Eastern Finland
- Local volunteers: open

The organizers welcome others to take part in planning, either in short or long term. We communicate via the CodeRefinery chat, #NoBSC channel. This is the same place that Nordic-RSE people hang out.

Supported by

- Aalto Scientific Computing (Science-IT): Staff time, sponsoring all facilities
- CSC - IT Center for Science (EuroCC2 project) : Staff time
- Software Sustainability Institute (through fellowship of Samantha Wittke): Travel funding, planning support
- [Society of Research Software Engineering](https://society-rse.org/) : Catering support

History of NoBSC

You could say this event was first inspired when Richard Darst went to the Nordic e-Infrastructure Collaboration conference in 2017. This event had a variety of infrastructure and open science people not advertising why their stuff was so good, but discussion how to make things better. (At least that's what it looks like with rose-colored glasses looking back.) This also kicked off the collaboration between ASC and CodeRefinery (a NeIC project dedicated to teaching basic software tools for researchers), which continues to this day.

CodeRefinery didn't feel like a collaboration not between organizations, but between the people in the trenches directly helping or users. This was an extremely productive collaboration, not just in the main teaching but in connecting people together to talk about their other jobs besides teaching.

In 2019, we had a meeting it Helsinki called Nordic HPC, basically a lot of the CodeRefinery staff who were supporters of smaller university-based computing clusters. We enjoyed talking and sharing ideas, but soon we became closer together because we were all working online, and our collaboration was focused on online events.

Now, in 2025, we are trying to meet again in person. Hopefully there are the best parts from NeIC conferences, NeIC all-hands meetings, and NordicHPC, with even more people welcome to attend.

In addition to the SciComp team meetup, we have noticed that Research Software Engineering community, or "researchers who code" appreciate the connection to each other too - and there is a lot of connections and career movement between the two groups. Samantha's fellowship with the Software Sustainability Institute looks at exactly that. Part of the fellowship is the contribution to the international RSE survey to get to know the Finnish and Nordic community needs a bit better. A short lunch meeting of RSE enthusiasts in Espoo to celebrate the international RSE day on October 9th 2025 was a good start to connect. For the Finnish RSE meetup, we aim to also get together RSE enthusiasts from all over the country, share what we do, learn from each other and also learn about the needs and wishes of the community.

Call for contributions

The theme of this conference is how we actually work and "the problems we found along the way", not "advertising our product". You can present ideas, what you couldn't do, things you need advice on, and so on. You can request time slots for lightning talks, normal talks, posters or suggest a discussion session. If there are too many long talk requests, we will open a voting for the time to not have to decline any submitted talks. Only the length may change.

RSE-FI vs SciComp teams

You can submit to either part in advance, but

- RSE-FI is more focused on advanced submissions
- SciComp teams is more focused on being an unconference (we collect ideas dynamically during the meeting and allocate time then)

Abstract submission link

https://indico.neic.no/event/284/abstracts/

Submit a contribution

You'll be able to submit talks, demos, or posters you'd like to present.

Our facilities include one main room (reserved), one breakout room (reserved), and several informal spaces throughout the building's lobby areas that can be used for smaller discussion sessions (not reserved).

Selection process: We will review all submissions to make sure they align with the spirit of the event. Our goal is to accept as many contributions as possible. If there are too many long talks submitted, our plan is to let attendees vote and allocate time slots based on those votes. When submitting, please keep your abstract concise and accessible to a general audience.

In short: Your contribution will most likely be accepted, the main question is how much time you'll have to present.

Deadline for submissions to get into the program is January 20 end of day in Nordics.

You will get to know about the length of your talk on January 21.

Contribution inspirations

You are allowed to come with a question instead of a solution.

- Introduction to how my team/organization works.
- Cool procedure/practice/tool we have developed.
- Cool software I have developed.
- Book/video/event review and summary.
- Problem or concern I am facing now.
- Demo or poster about something you would like to have input on.

You can request how long your session should be: lightning talk (10 min), 20 min talk, poster/demo spot. You will get to know your assigned length in time before the event.

Unconference

We'll also set aside time for an unconference: sessions that can be proposed or requested on the spot during the event. Maybe you'll invite someone to run a session inspired by an informal coffee conversation, or you'll discover that several attendees are curious to hear more about something you're working on. The unconference time is meant exactly for those spontaneous, interest-driven sessions.

Schedule

When to attend

- **For the Finnish-RSE meetup**, attend lunch on 2 Feb to lunch or dinner on 3 Feb.
- **For the SciComp team meetup**, attend 3 Feb until lunch on Feb 4.
- The overlapping day is events of interest to both groups.
- You are of course welcome to attend more, if you would like.

Rough draft

Day	Topic	General plan
2 February	RSE	• 11:00 start time • Lunch • 17:00 End of day • Evening: Semi-organized dinner
3 February	Interesting overlap of day1/day2	• 9:00 start time • Lunch • 17:00 End of day • Evening: Semi-organized dinner
4 February	SciComp/RSE teams	• 9:00 start time • Lunch • ~13:00 Ending

List of sessions

This list currently only has the pre-planned "keynote" sessions invited by the organizers for the SciComp meetup (the second half).

Discussion: The current hardest legal questions in research data and computing

We often hear clear-cut instructions about legal matters in research (copyright, data, ethics, intellectual property, and especially AI these days). Yet humans are behind the scenes, reading and interpreting the legislation, court cases and legal literature and producing these guidelines, and it isn't always so clear-cut. This is a discussion with Maria Rehbinder, Legal Counsel, Aalto University, where we'll peek "behind the cutains" at some of the open questions going around right now, especially related to AI. This will start a two-way discussion about all of these legal matters.

Maria Rehbinder is a Senior Legal Counsel at Aalto University. Her traditional standard projects included copyright, trademarks, and design rights, but more recently has been involved in the initial implementation work of legislation such as the GDPR, AI Act, and Digital Services Act. Maria serves as a member in the Copyright Commission and the Copyright Council of the Ministry of Education and Culture and as a member in the Rights ManagementCommittee of Open Research and Science 2014-2017 initiative of the ministry.

The role of Research Software Engineers and SciComp teams in universities

What is the role of Research Software Engineers, and teams of them, in universities in the future? Heikki Manilla was president of the Research Council of Finland (then the Academy of Finland) from 2012-2022 and now the director of the "House of AI", an Aalto project helping to connect various disciplines in the use of AI and scientific computing. Heikki will present the funders' side of things and give some vision for how research engineer and scientific computing teams can be made sustainable in the future.

Cool things and problems

Our icebreaker of the workshop, and starting point for sharing ideas. Everyone (hopefully grouped into teams from their organization) can present one slide of three cool things they have done lately, and one slide of three problems they are facing lately. We will quickly go through these and use the talk as a starting point for discussion - maybe a few unconference talks can be requested from it.

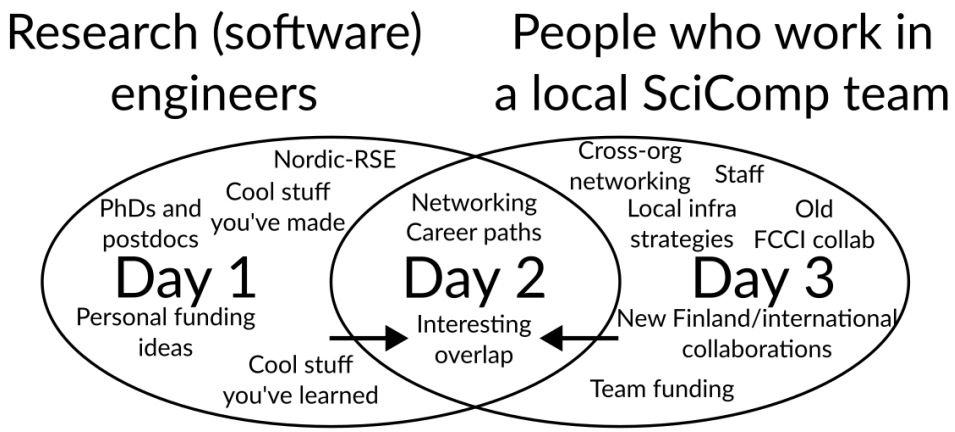
The session will be built from a shared editable slide deck. Attendees will get contribution instructions (+ more details) closer to the event.

Panel discussion: New HPC user perspective

Panel discussions are usually full of the most senior people the organizers can find. In this discussion, we'll hear from junior researchers, just started in their HPC/SciComp journey, about how usable they see computing systems and the onboarding process.

Nordic Basic Scientific Computing is a gathering of everyone interested in supporting scientific computing (and a celebration of the diverse work that makes it all possible). Aalto Scientific Computing invites you to its homebase at Otaniemi Campus, 2-4 February 2026.

This event is split into two halves: **The first half is a** Finnish+friends RSE meetup **, the second half is a** meetup of Finnish scientific computing teams more targeted to service staff**. The overlapping middle day has events that are interesting to both audiences. People are welcome to attend both halves.**



This event focuses on practical discussion and experience-sharing in the world of RSE and SciComp. Whether you develop research software, support researchers through local computing services or you are simply curious about these roles, this is gathering for you. It's a time to roll up our sleeves, look under the hood and talk about what's really going on.

Schedule (general plan)

See also

Schedule

- Day 1 (Mo, 2 Feb 2026): RSE meetup, starting with lunch at 11
- Day 2 (Tu, 3 Feb 2026): RSE/SciComp overlap day: events, lunch, evening dinner, some social activities scattered between.
- Day 3 (We: 4 Feb 2026): SciComp team meetup: events 9-12, lunch.

Quick info

See also

Practical info

Location: Dipoli, Otaniemi Campus, Aalto University, Espoo, Helsinki area, Finland

Price: Free

Program: You can submit talks and other events in advance, but we also plan an "unconference session" (program decided by attendees)..

Key dates:

- 5 December: Registration opens (closes when full)
- Rolling acceptance of talks, posters/demos
- 20 January: Abstract submission deadline (every suitable abstract submitted until this date will get a spot in the program)
- 21 January: Talk length decided (latest)
- 2-4 February: Nordic Basic Scientific Computing event

RSE-FI flyer, SciComp teams flyer

Registration

We will provide long times for coffee breaks and lunches and make sure that everyone can find an engaging group to be a part of.

The event is intended to be relatively small to facilitate networking.

Online attendance: We've chosen to hold this event in person only, as we believe it offers the best environment for meaningful networking and a more engaging, collaborative atmosphere.

Registration link

https://indico.neic.no/event/284/registrations/